



Magic Leap's AR dev tools

Magic Leap unveiled 'Creator Portal' where developers can join the platform and begin developing AR content for the platform. <http://dgit.in/MLARDev>



Instagram gets somewhat chronological

Instagram has decided to tweak its algorithm to display newer posts first so that users don't miss out. <http://dgit.in/InstaChronology>

apps, as most app analytics platforms stop tracking a user after 15 seconds of inactivity. Don't even get us started on the ability of apps to send targeted push notifications and alerts to users - websites are only catching up to that now.

WHY NOW?

Analytics = tracking, yet, merely tracking MORE data doesn't always lead to better analytics. Choosing the right metrics is as important. There couldn't be a more relevant time, even though apps have been around for a while. There are more apps than ever before now, and multiple app analytics startups have been acquired or funded in 2017. There are a few important reasons behind that:

- **Analytics for product improvement:** App analytics has gone much beyond marketing, and at this point, analysing user uninstalls or drop-offs shows developers where they need to make improvements.
- **Opportunity cost:** Today, users are literally flooded with promotional messages and push notifications, so

moengage

MoEngage is a user engagement and analytics platform

it is important to make them contextual and personalised - and that requires knowing their behavior.

- **Return on investment:** Comparing the cost of user acquisition via different channels, of which there are too many today, with the marketing investment shows companies where to put their money.

There are different ways in which companies are putting both new and tested metrics to use. MoEngage, a user engagement and analytics platform, outlines many such app analytics metrics as a part of its offerings. "Chillr - (a) multi-bank payment and transactions app," explains Nalin Goel, Product Head at MoEngage, "combines business intelligence data like customer micro-moments, cus-

tomers transaction insights, and such with app analytics to drive customer engagement. Key Metrics such as Usage, DAUs/MAUs, Conversions, Sessions & Funnels have become basic in mobile app analytics."

STATE OF THE ART

Beyond the metrics, there's technology at play that makes app analytics what it is today. Companies like MoEngage and Clevertap have employed machine learning and AI to predict user behavior successfully based on the data

available to them. Data is not just analysed to create insights based on 'what doesn't work' but also to identify possible solutions based on 'what works'.

Even in the choice of metrics, companies that offer analytics services are gradually moving on to more relevant metrics. Beyond things like downloads, opens and crashes, focus has moved to retention and repeated conversion to increase something known as the Lifetime Value (LTV) of a customer - which is essentially a prediction of the net profit attributed to the entire future relationship with a customer. Tools like Dynamic Product Messaging from MoEngage that implements AI and Machine learning to send highly customised push notifications is an example of this focus in action.

This new direction has led to things like qualitative analytics taking importance over from sheer numbers - answering questions like 'why does the app crash?', 'why does a user leave from a particular screen?' has brought in tools like touch heatmaps and user session recording analysis. In addition to this, a strong focus right now is to reduce the number of SDKs that are required for app analytics to make the life of developers easier.

THE FUTURE

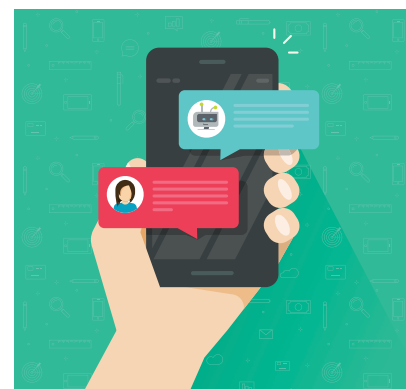
There is a lot of talk around bots replacing apps, which is very similar to the popular sentiment that emerged



App heatmaps help you understand the 'why' behind basic analytics data

back when apps launched about apps replacing websites. The results will most likely be pretty similar as well. Apps aren't going anywhere any time soon. However, that does not mean that we can discount the usefulness, and hence, significance of chatbots when it comes to analytics. They are seeing increasing usage as a point of contact between a user and a company, and not taking chatbots into account in any marketing and analytics offerings going forward would be shortsighted.

"Chatbots will work with apps and websites in the future to enable better customer service.", says Nalin Goel, "Similarly, we can witness an increasing trend, where analytics from chatbots will be integrated with analytics data from the app and website. Analytical data from chatbots can be used to



Incorporating chatbot analytics into app analytics platform might prove beneficial, although just like apps, they might eventually require their own analytics platforms

predict customer behavior, their level of satisfaction with the product/ service and even serve customers better."

On the other hand, tech like augmented reality and smart assistant devices are pointing toward a different future - one without apps as we know them. In that future, app analytics will have to evolve into a new paradigm or perish as an archaic tool that will be of no use to anyone but historians.